Core web app. You can add other features, such as configuration and logging, using various libraries.

When you add an ASP.NET Core web server to your .NET 7 app, your console application can run as a web application. ASP.NET Core contains a huge number of APIs, but you'll rarely need all the features available to you. Some of the features are built in and will appear in virtually every application you create, such as the ones for reading configuration files or performing logging. Other features are provided by separate libraries and built on top of these base capabilities to provide application-specific functionality, such as third-party logins via Facebook or Google.

Most of the libraries and APIs you'll use in ASP.NET Core are available on GitHub, in the Microsoft .NET organization repositories at https://github.com/dotnet/aspnetcore. You can find the core APIs there, including the authentication and logging APIs, as well as many peripheral libraries, such as the third-party authentication libraries.

All ASP.NET Core applications follow a similar design for basic configuration, but in general the framework is flexible, leaving you free to create your own code conventions. These common APIs, the extension libraries that build on them, and the design conventions they promote are covered by the somewhat-nebulous term ASP.NET Core.

2.3 Understanding the many paradigms of ASP.NET Core

In chapter 1 you learned that ASP.NET Core provides a generalized web framework that can be used to build a wide variety of applications. As you may recall from section 1.2, the main paradigms are